

Apprenticeships & Earn-While-You-Learn

Apprenticeships let you earn a paycheck while you train for a skilled career — often with no student debt. Below are the main national resources. Tick the box once you've checked each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

Apprenticeships are one of the best-kept secrets in career building: you get paid from day one, learn on the job, and finish with a respected credential and little or no debt.

1 Find an Apprenticeship

The official place to search paid apprenticeships nationwide.

☐ Apprenticeship.gov

Search registered apprenticeships in 1,000+ careers — from trades to healthcare to tech.

→ www.apprenticeship.gov/apprenticeship-job-finder

☐ American Job Center Help

Free local help finding and applying for apprenticeships.

→ www.careeronestop.org/LocalHelp/local-help.aspx

2 Explore the Fields

Apprenticeships go far beyond construction.

☐ Skilled Trades

Electrician, plumber, HVAC, and more — strong pay and steady demand.

→ www.apprenticeship.gov/apprenticeship-industries

☐ Healthcare, Tech & Business

Growing apprenticeships in nursing, IT, finance, and other fields.

→ www.apprenticeship.gov/apprenticeship-industries

3 Pre-Apprenticeships & Unions

On-ramps that prepare you and connect you to programs.

☐ Pre-Apprenticeship Programs

Short programs that prepare you to enter a full apprenticeship. Ask your Job Center.

→ www.apprenticeship.gov/career-seekers/explore-pre-apprenticeship

☐ Union Apprenticeships

Unions in construction and trades run respected, paid apprenticeships — often free to you.

→ www.apprenticeship.gov

4 Special Pathways

Targeted apprenticeship support for specific groups.

☐ Apprenticeships for Veterans & Youth

Veterans can use GI Bill benefits during apprenticeships; young people have dedicated programs.

→ www.apprenticeship.gov/career-seekers

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Registered apprenticeships are free to apply for and pay you to learn — never pay a fee to “get into” one. Use the official [Apprenticeship.gov](https://www.apprenticeship.gov) finder to avoid scams.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Apprenticeship graduates often earn strong wages with no student debt. If you’re choosing between an expensive program and an apprenticeship in the same field, the apprenticeship usually wins.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need help where you live?

This guide covers national programs. For apprenticeships and pre-apprenticeships near you, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
